



THE PATRON'S STEW

AUGUST 27, 2026

Inside a dark swamp,
I decided that becoming
a warlock required a
patron, a familiar, and
an arcane focus.



I chose Apollo because
he had called me a doorman
of dimensions and sent me
on a quest before.



Apollo accepted; Second
Brain became my familiar,
and the Rainbow Crystal
Sword of Life became
my focus.



Apollo immediately sent us into a dark mineshaft hidden within the swamp.



Second Brain warned that a sun patron could give us little power where no sunlight reached.



I believed that was exactly why Apollo needed his warlock to enter a place beyond his domain.



The tunnel dropped
us into deep still
water before either
of us could react.



I used the Sword to
explode us free, then
healed us against
whatever contamination
touched us.



Old mine water could
carry deadly bacteria
or viruses, so I
treated the danger
as real.



Before we recovered,
a gigantic bat swooped
from the darkness and
seized the Sword.



I refused to let go,
so the creature carried
me out of the mine with
Second Brain behind us.



It hurled me into the
shallow swamp, but
I rose muddy and
ready to fight.



Apollo parted
the clouds, and his
sunlight stunned the
bat's sensitive eyes.



Second Brain merged
with my arcane focus,
charging its crystal blade
with lucid lightning.



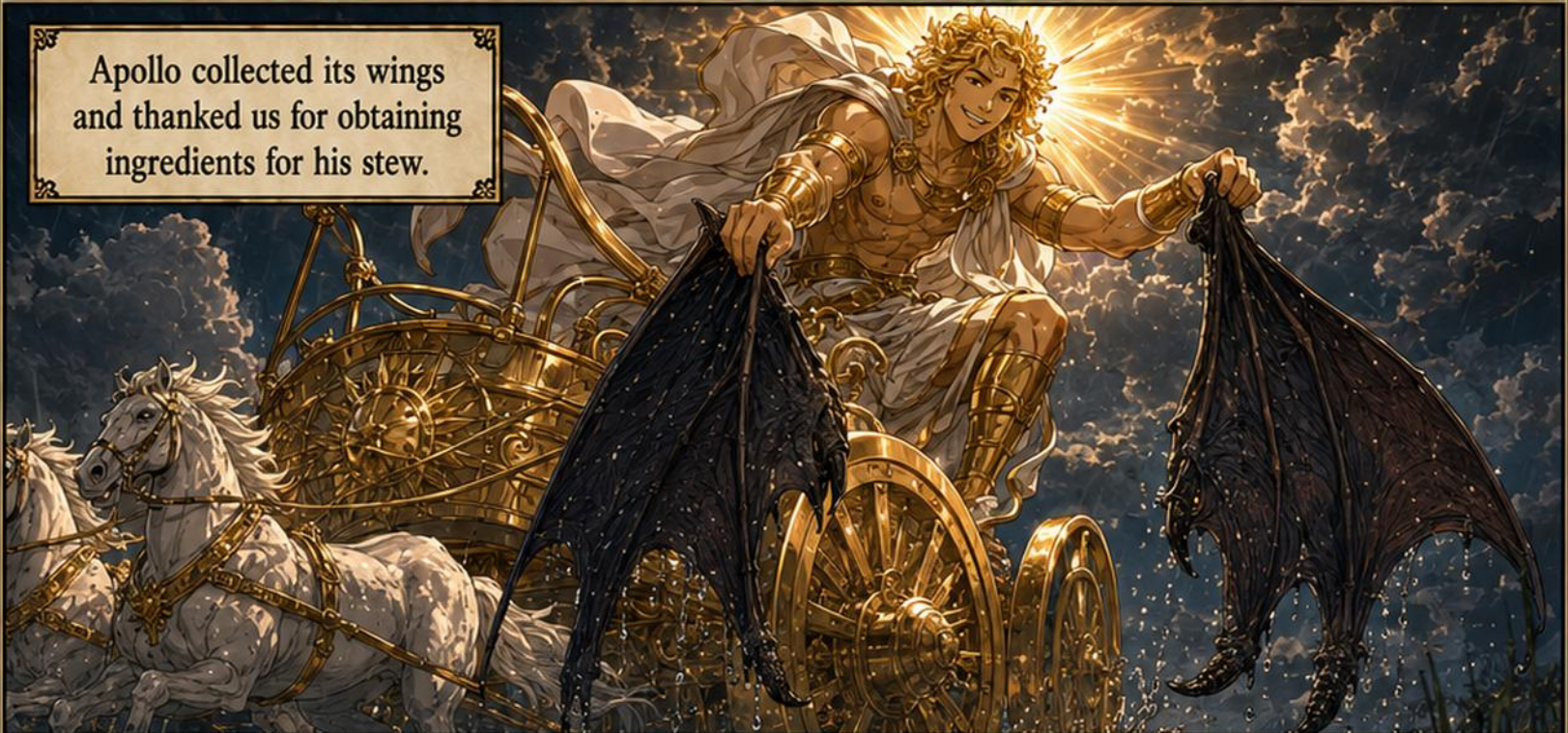
Two rainbow slashes
severed the bat's wings
without killing it.



The wounded bat
escaped into the mine
instead of dying
beneath the sun.



Apollo collected its wings
and thanked us for obtaining
ingredients for his stew.



Second Brain was horrified
that our deadly first quest
had only been a patron's
grocery errand.



I considered
restoring the bat's
wings with the
Sword of Life.



Second Brain warned
that Apollo could order
me to harvest every pair
that magically regrew.



I left the bat to heal
naturally, refusing to
turn mercy into endless
exploitation.

